converting goods retailers into retailers of goods and services; and 'Uberizing' service providers by linking demand and supply of these services. This programme has the potential for doubling the people in retail. The transformation of goods-only retail stores into goods and services retail stores and their digitalization has a much better chance of making them competitive businesses to e-commerce companies. E-commerce platforms like Meesho seek to make home workers small retailers, leveraging the power and ease of digital technology. Several start-ups have come up which are retailing urban services. These platforms need to be provided a supportive policy framework.

Second, the government must actively pursue digitalization of trade services providers. The proposal to register and recognize every unincorporated business (traders are the largest such businesses outside farms) and improving their access to financiers, the taxman and people in general would help immensely. The government should support creation of appropriate networks to help retailers manage their suppliers, customers, staff, accounting, tax filing, and all other tasks.

Third, a lot of policy capital is being wasted in trying to make artificial constructs like the inventory model versus platform model, prohibiting collection of necessary data on the buyer and payment mechanism in the name of privacy of data, and permitting FDI in single-brand retail but not in multi-brand retail. These policies will only make India non-competitive.

All these restrictive policies should be replaced with regulation where no one has a conflict of interest in selling products and discouraging the sale of competing products.

Fintechization of Financial Services the Best Bet

There are three main segments of financial services businesses: payments, investments and credit. While Fintech is fast becoming mainstream in the financial business in India, it needs a lot of policy support.